Lab Documentation: Design a Pricing Plans Layout Page

Platform: freeCodeCamp — Responsive Web Design Certification

Project: Design a Pricing Plans Layout Page

1. Overview & Objectives

The goal of this lab activity was to build a clean, responsive, and interactive "Pricing Plans" layout using **HTML5** and **CSS Flexbox**. The implementation focuses on proper card layout techniques, emphasis on featured tiers, custom typography, micro-interactions (hover states), and visual hierarchy.

2. Technical Workflow & Implementation

Phase 1: HTML Document Structure (`index.html`)

1. **Head Meta Tags & Setup:**
    - Declared `<!DOCTYPE html>` with proper language and character encoding (`UTF-8`).
    - Included a responsive viewport meta tag (`width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0`) to ensure mobile readiness.
    - Linked the external stylesheet (`styles.css`).

2. **DOM Architecture:**
    - Created a top-level heading (`<h1>Pricing Plans</h1>`).
    - Constructed a main container (`div.pricing-container`) to hold all pricing cards.
    - Defined three distinct pricing card components:
        - `.pricing-card.basic-plan`
        - `.pricing-card.pro-plan`
        - `.pricing-card.premium-plan`
    - Styled inner content elements using semantically appropriate tags: heading (`<h2>`), price indicators (`<p>`), features lists (`<ul>`/`<li>`), and call-to-action (`<button>`) elements.

Phase 2: CSS Layout & Styling (`styles.css`)

1. **Flexbox Container Setup (`.pricing-container`):**
    - Applied `display: flex` with `flex-wrap: wrap` to allow cards to wrap naturally on smaller screens.
    - Used `justify-content: center` to center cards horizontally and `align-items: stretch` so all cards default to equal height.
    - Added a `gap: 1.5rem` for clean spacing between cards without using legacy margin hacks.

2. **Base Pricing Card Component (`.pricing-card`):**
    - Configured `display: flex` and `flex-direction: column` to stack inner elements vertically.
    - Utilized `justify-content: space-between` to force call-to-action buttons to align neatly at the bottom of each card.
    - Set flex sizing constraints using `flex: 1 1 250px` and `max-width: 320px` for consistent card boundaries.
    - Styled cards with `border-radius: 12px`, soft background colors, distinct borders (`#e2e8f0`), and subtle drop shadows (`box-shadow`).

3. **Flexbox Ordering & Visual Hierarchy:**
    - Utilized the `order` property to enforce explicit visual positioning (`.basic-plan { order: 0 }`, `.pro-plan { order: 1 }`, `.premium-plan { order: 2 }`).
    - Enhanced the **Pro Plan** (featured tier) by giving it a distinct blue accent border (`#2563eb`), a highlighted background (`#f0f7ff`), and scaling on hover (`transform: scale(1.03) translateY(-4px)`).

4. **Typography & Interactive States:**
    - Formatted headers (`.pricing-card h2`), price text (`.pricing-card .price`), features list (`.pricing-card ul`), and custom buttons (`.pricing-card button`).
    - Added fluid transitions (`transition: transform 0.2s ease, box-shadow 0.2s ease`) on cards and primary action buttons for smooth visual feedback during user hover interactions.

3. Knowledge Gained & Key Takeaways

- **Flexbox Layout Mastery:** Practical experience leveraging `display: flex`, flex wrapping, alignment properties, and flex basis values to create responsive grid-like structures without relying on heavy CSS grid overhead.

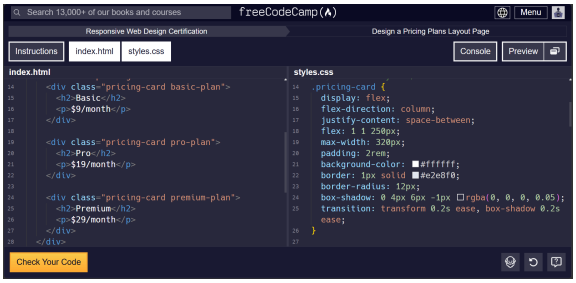
- **Visual Hierarchy in UI Design:** Learned how subtle contrast adjustments—such as background color shifts, custom borders, visual scaling, and explicit `order` properties—draw immediate user attention to priority pricing tiers (e.g., the Pro Plan).

- **CSS Micro-Interactions:** Mastery over combining CSS `transform` (translating along the Y-axis and scaling) with `box-shadow` and smooth `transition` timing functions to create responsive UI feedback.

- **Maintainable Component CSS:** Structuring CSS using base classes (`.pricing-card`) for shared code alongside modifier classes (`.pro-plan`, `.premium-plan`) to keep styles DRY and scalable.

CODE:















PREVIEW:

